

Chapter 76 - Two Sides

Yan Lin spent the entire night under the streetlight across from the small villa. It wasn't until dawn broke and revealed a hint of morning light that she finally moved her stiff legs and prepared to leave.

After leaving, Yan Lin went directly back to the hotel. She didn't plan to sleep anymore, wanting to settle the housing matter as quickly as possible today.

Her overnight rush to Vancouver did indeed contain impulsive elements, but more than that was her worry and confusion about Feng Yue.

That bucket list had indeed shocked her, but what she wanted to know more was why Feng Yue was so certain that her death date in this life would arrive on schedule just like in the previous life, even though her condition was clearly improving.

Yan Lin believed there must be something she didn't know about, or something Feng Yue was still hiding from her.

It was precisely this matter that made Feng Yue certain she would die on May 4th just like in her previous life.

She wanted to find an opportunity to have a good talk with Feng Yue. Even if Feng Yue still wouldn't tell her the truth in the end, she would still do everything in her power to save her.

The scene she witnessed when she was just one step too late—Yan Lin never wanted to experience it again.

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Feng Yue rested for three or four full days at her uncle's house before finally recovering from the curse of jet lag.

Perhaps it was also because her health wasn't very good, as among the whole family, she rested the longest, going to bed early every day, leaving Jiang Ming with no time to take her out to play.

This morning, Feng Yue rarely didn't stay in bed, waking up in a state of full energy.

Jiang Ming and Jiang Zhao, who were huddled in the living room playing games, were a bit surprised to see her up so early.

"Xiao Yue, good morning! You're up so early today, why don't you sleep a bit more?" Jiang Ming threw down her game controller and bounced over to Feng Yue's side in two or three hops, not caring whether the game was finished or not.

Jiang Zhao looked at the game screen where their team had been wiped out because his teammate suddenly stopped moving, and gritted his teeth.

Stay calm, stay calm.

"Good morning, cousin brother and sister. I couldn't sleep anymore so I got up. Did you two get up this early too?"

Jiang Zhao stood up and unplugged both controllers, saying expressionlessly: "Catherine¹ begged me to help her through this level. We've been playing all night without any sign of success."

As he spoke, Jiang Zhao took off the blue light filtering glasses he was wearing and wearily pinched the corners of his eyes.

"What do you mean I begged you? If this level didn't require two people to play together, I wouldn't have asked you!" Jiang Ming protested.

Feng Yue looked at the dark circles under both their eyes and asked with concern: "Why don't you go sleep for a while? I'll cook something delicious for you at lunch today, and I'll call you when it's ready."

Both of them had been craving Feng Yue's cooking for a long time. In the past few days, they had only eaten the dumplings Feng Yue made, and hadn't tried her regular dishes yet.

So at the mention of this, much of their fatigue from staying up all night dissipated.

"I won't sleep, I can help you in the kitchen!" Jiang Ming was the first to speak.

Jiang Zhao struck her down without changing expression: "You help? You'd probably just be getting in the way."

Seeing that the two were about to start arguing, Feng Yue quickly pushed Jiang Ming into the kitchen, physically cutting off their conflict.

"Cousin brother, cousin sister and I will go bake some snacks in the kitchen first. You can rest for a bit!"

With Feng Yue mediating, the siblings naturally didn't start fighting. However, Jiang Ming, who was pulled away, was still somewhat indignant.

While the two were busy in the kitchen, Feng Yue remembered that she hadn't seen the adults at home.

She asked Jiang Ming curiously: "Cousin sister, where are uncle and my mom? Why didn't I see them?"

Jiang Ming was helping wash things and replied: "They went out early in the morning with grandpa and grandma, saying they were going to visit some old friend. They told us to eat whatever we wanted at home."

Feng Yue nodded in understanding.

Speaking of this, Jiang Ming remembered something else. She stopped what she was doing and moved closer to Feng Yue: "Xiao Yue, you should have rested well these past few days, right?"

Feng Yue nodded: "Yes, the environment here is very good, and I've gotten over the jet lag." What Feng Yue said was true. Since coming to terms with reality, she hadn't rested as well as she had these past few days in a long time.

"Then let's go out for dinner tonight! After dinner, I'll take you to Liz² and introduce you to some friends. That way, even if I have to go out for performances later, you won't be bored without anyone to keep you company." Jiang Ming's eyes sparkled.

Feng Yue couldn't say she disliked or liked places like bars, but since Jiang Ming had mentioned it twice, it wouldn't be good to refuse again, so she agreed.

"But cousin sister, what about cousin brother if we go out for dinner?"

"Let him drop dead." Jiang Ming waved her hand dismissively.

Jiang Zhao, who had just walked to the kitchen door to help Jiang Ming: ...

Nobody better stop him—today he was going to clean house!

At lunch, the siblings properly tasted Feng Yue's cooking and were absolutely amazed.

After lunch, Jiang Ming dragged Feng Yue back to her room, determined to make Feng Yue the most dazzling one at the venue tonight.

But after trying on outfit after outfit, Feng Yue finally just put on a cream-colored wool coat, with a tight knit sweater and plaid skirt underneath, paired with over-the-knee patent leather boots—clean and neat yet alluring.

As for Jiang Ming, her outfit was very much in line with her image as a band drummer—leather jacket and bustier, with black pants, but the most distinctive feature was the pink leather choker³ around her neck.

The two looked like they were from completely different worlds based on their outfits, but once they started talking, one could feel the harmonious atmosphere between them.

The two spent nearly three hours getting ready at home before finally picking up their bags and preparing to go downstairs.

Who knew that Jiang Zhao had been waiting at the foot of the stairs for ages. When he saw Jiang Ming's outfit that completely ignored the outside temperature, his temple throbbed twice out of habit.

Jiang Zhao had prepared two thick, long down jackets and chose to throw one of them to Jiang Ming.

"What are you doing? I'm not wearing this thing, it's too ugly." Jiang Ming pouted.

Jiang Zhao looked at her expressionlessly: "Not wearing it? Then try to see if you can successfully leave this house today."

Seeing that Jiang Ming was about to explode at the slightest provocation, Feng Yue quickly spoke to soothe her: "Cousin sister, you should put it on. I can see it might snow outside, and you really are dressed a bit lightly. If you catch a cold, there won't be anyone to take me out to play later!"

Feng Yue's effective soothing perfectly calmed Jiang Ming down. In the end, Jiang Ming just glared fiercely at Jiang Zhao and snorted.

"Cousin brother, we're heading out then." Feng Yue smiled at Jiang Zhao.

Jiang Zhao nodded: "Be safe on the road, come home early, and contact me if anything happens."

"Okay, goodbye cousin brother."

"Mm."

Even after they got in the car, Jiang Ming was still huffing angrily. But soon she didn't have time to be angry because her friends were already calling her.

Since there were about five people coming to the gathering, the restaurant they went to this time wasn't one of those quiet, intimate Western restaurants, but a small Southeast Asian cuisine shop hidden in the streets.

When they arrived, it was just around 5 PM. The shop owner was Thai, and when he saw Jiang Ming, he greeted her familiarly—clearly Jiang Ming was a regular customer here.

This shop was quite small, and the sign outside was very simple and compact, but once inside, it was a different world entirely.

The warm yellow lighting and greenery everywhere gave one the illusion of forgetting the freezing cold outside and suddenly being transported to a tropical country.

Jiang Ming's friends had already arrived—five people in total. Including Jiang Ming and herself, there were seven people, all girls.

When Feng Yue first thought about Jiang Ming's friends, she imagined they might all be the same cool and sassy type as her, but that wasn't the case.

Among those five people, at least three had a strong academic atmosphere, while the other two were from Jiang Ming's band.

Jiang Ming introduced all her friends to Feng Yue one by one. One of the academically-oriented girls, Dana⁴, was the friend who had helped Jiang Ming take care of that Chinese rose.

Feng Yue indeed got along best with her, with most of their conversation revolving around plants.

From their conversation, Feng Yue also got a general sense of her personality. Dana was a passionate plant enthusiast who was determined to dedicate her entire life to plant research.

Feng Yue really envied her spirit of dedicating everything to what she loved, so they talked a lot.

Even when they finished dinner and the group prepared to move to Liz, the two still felt they hadn't talked enough.

But Dana also made plans with Feng Yue to take her to visit the botanical garden where she worked.

Feng Yue naturally agreed happily.

However, deep down Feng Yue was still a bit curious about how these people became Jiang Ming's friends—they seemed like they were from completely different worlds.

But after arriving at Liz, Feng Yue completely understood why.

Among the seven people, except for her who didn't drink, the other six became as comfortable as fish in water once they got to the bar, all ordering their usual drinks.

After drinking, the six people seemed to unleash their true nature, becoming passionate and uninhibited, leaving Feng Yue stunned.

Although this was Feng Yue's first time getting along with such people, she didn't feel repulsed at all—instead, she found it very interesting.

Jiang Ming saw Feng Yue sitting there happily and moved over with her wine glass, her whole body emanating a sweet wine scent: "How is it? My friends are all pretty interesting, right!"

"Yes, very different from what I expected."

"Hahaha, did you think it was strange at first that I was friends with them, but after seeing them after they'd had some drinks, you understood?" Jiang Ming leaned back against the chair back, relaxing.

Feng Yue nodded.

"So you see, humans are a multi-faceted species." Jiang Ming pointed to one of her other academically-oriented friends: "Her—you heard just now, right? She's a surgeon who was exceptionally admitted to Saint-Maur Hospital⁵, a genius in the medical field, but actually her father is the head of Canada's largest organized crime group."

"This one, our band's lead singer, her actual day job is as a nun practicing at the city church."

"And this one..."

The more Feng Yue listened, the more interesting she found it. Looking at it this way, she and Jiang Ming had become the most ordinary ones among them.

"Humans are very complex animals. Only when you get to know them deeply will you discover their most interesting parts." Jiang Ming successfully concluded her introductions with this sentence.

And she herself also successfully succumbed to alcohol, even spilling the drink from her glass all over herself.

Feng Yue looked at her wet chest, then at her group of friends who were too drunk to know which direction they were facing, and had no choice but to resignedly help Jiang Ming to the restroom to clean up.

Jiang Ming was completely intoxicated, with almost all her body weight pressing on Feng Yue, and the bar was very dark. Feng Yue kept getting tripped by other people's feet or bumped by other drunks.

Just as she was about to reach the restroom with Jiang Ming, she saw a bearded man heading straight toward them.

She knew that carrying Jiang Ming, she couldn't avoid him and would have to take the hit.

But at that moment, a hand reached out from her side, pulling both her and Jiang Ming a good distance aside, and the bearded man fell and crashed in front of them.

A familiar voice also sounded behind Feng Yue.

"Be careful."

Footnotes:

1. **Catherine:** Jiang Ming's English name, as mentioned in previous chapters, many Chinese people living abroad adopt English names.
2. **Liz:** A bar or club name that was mentioned in the previous chapter when Jiang Ming first suggested taking Feng Yue there.
3. **Choker:** A close-fitting necklace worn around the neck, often made of leather, velvet, or other materials. Popular in various fashion subcultures.
4. **Dana:** The English name of Jiang Ming's friend who works at the botanical garden and helped care for the Chinese rose.
5. **Saint-Maur Hospital:** A fictional hospital name, suggesting a prestigious medical institution.